

Template - Building Sustainable Cities: Learning from Madrid's City Systems

Emily G. Fagan

Language Assistant at IES Antonio Fraguas "Forges"

Massive Open Online Course Final Project

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Final Assignment Title: *Building Sustainable Cities - Learning from Madrid's City Systems*

Topic: Sustainability

Subject Area: Global Studies / Environmental Education

Student's grade: 1 ESO

Describe why your Final Assignment is useful or original for your students.

This assignment connects the concepts of sustainability to a system the students interact with daily: Madrid's transportation system. By exploring real-world examples, students gain practical insights into sustainability while developing problem-solving skills. The local focus makes it relatable and helps foster a sense of civic responsibility and social awareness.

Describe how the teaching materials and practices presented in your assignment effectively foster learning and how they might be adaptable to other contexts, such as different age levels or subject areas.

The project includes hands-on activities, group work, and multimedia resources that cater to different learning styles. While this unit focuses on transportation, it can be adapted for other city systems like water or electricity. The students will be able to choose their own city system to present on and can be adapted to different cities, grade levels, and systems. Adjusting complexity levels and integrating other curricular themes can make it suitable for different grades or subjects, such as science or geography.

What topic are you teaching?

Sustainability and how Madrid's transportation system can become more environmentally friendly.

What are your objectives?

1. Understand the concept of sustainability and its importance.
2. Learn about the structure and operations of Madrid's transportation system.
3. Analyze its environmental impact and identify areas for improvement.
4. Propose innovative and practical solutions for sustainability challenges.

What materials are you going to use?

- Videos about Madrid's Metro and EMT buses
- Maps and infographics of the city's transportation system
- Slideshows for lessons
- Worksheets for brainstorming and project planning
- Rubrics for peer evaluation

What is the timing for your lesson?

This unit will span three class periods, approximately 50 minutes each:

Day 1: Introduction to sustainability and city systems.

Day 2: Deep dive into Madrid's transportation system and sustainability challenges.

Day 3: Group presentations and peer feedback.

What is the teacher's role?

The teacher will facilitate discussions, provide context on sustainability, and guide students during research and group activities. They will also assess the presentations and reflections.

What is your role as a LA?

As a Language Assistant, I will support students during brainstorming sessions and group work, ensuring they use English to communicate their ideas. I will provide language support for presentations and help create materials like slides and rubrics.

How are you and the teacher working to complement each other?

The teacher will lead the lessons and ensure curriculum alignment, while I will focus on student engagement, language accuracy, and creative aspects of the project. We will collaborate to design activities and assessments.

What activities are the students going to do?

- Watch videos and analyze infographics about Madrid's transportation system.
- Brainstorm sustainability challenges in small groups.
- Propose solutions and create a group presentation.
- Present their ideas to the class and provide feedback using rubrics.

In what other activities organized by your school have you participated as a language assistant?

This project was inspired by the Global Scholars curriculum, which emphasizes the importance of sustainable cities and provides a wonderful opportunity for students to engage with this critical topic. Additionally, I assist in music classes and Cambridge exam preparation. I also participate in music and theatre field trips with 1 ESO, enriching their learning experiences outside the classroom.

What exactly did your collaboration as an assistant in the implementation of these extracurricular activities consist of?

I helped students develop their projects in English, facilitated discussions, and provided feedback on their work. I also assisted in creating presentations and organizing materials. In music classes, I provide language support and participate in activities. During field trips, I help supervise students and encourage them to engage with cultural content in English.

How will your proposal respond to different learning styles and different levels of achievement among students?

Visual learners will benefit from the use of videos, maps, and infographics that provide clear and engaging representations of Madrid's transportation system. Auditory learners will engage through group discussions and class presentations, allowing them to process and articulate their ideas verbally. Kinesthetic learners will participate actively in creating posters and brainstorming activities, providing them with hands-on opportunities to express their creativity.

Differentiation will also be achieved by using scaffolding techniques, assigning group roles that match students' strengths, and tailoring rubrics to support varying proficiency levels.